Pattern Headings: Languages

H 1154

Patterns: *English language*; *French language*; *Romance languages*

A. Recent revisions 1
B. Types of headings covered by the pattern 1
C. Conflicts 1
D. New Subdivisions 2
E. Special provisions for multiple subdivisions 2
F. Period subdivisions 3
G. List of topical subdivisions 3
H. List of form subdivisions 16
Revision history 21

A. Recent revisions

2026-04: Updated template. Added new free-floating subdivision --Null object.

B. Types of headings covered by the pattern

Headings for individual languages and groups of languages, including named dialects, artificial languages, and sign languages. Also included are headings formed using the free-floating subdivision ***--Languages*** under ethnic groups and names of countries, cities, etc. *Examples*: ***Danish language***; ***Indo-European languages***; ***Navajo language***; ***Abung dialect***; ***Esperanto***; ***Indians of North America--Languages***; ***Gabon--Languages***; ***New York (N.Y.)--Languages***. The category does not include the heading ***Language and languages***.

C. Conflicts

C.1. General rule

Any subdivision listed here can be used as a free-floating subdivision under any heading belonging to the category if it is appropriate and no conflict exists in the subject authority file. Subject authority records may exist for headings employing variant phrases or subdivisions equivalent to subdivisions on this list.

C.2. LC practice

If an exceptional variant form is to be retained, make a UF reference from the equivalent free-floating subdivision form following the procedures in H 195 if the reference does not yet exist. Otherwise, submit a proposal to change the variant form along with all bibliographic records requiring correction following the procedures in H 193.

D. New Subdivisions

Establish new subdivisions under *__English language__*, if possible, or if it is not possible, under *__French language__* for individual languages or *__Romance languages__* for groups of languages. Subdivisions listed below which are not valid under *__English language__* are indicated in the Notes column.

E. Special provisions for multiple subdivisions

The multiple subdivisions that appear on these lists are being cancelled in favor of specifically established heading strings (Cf. H 1090).

E.1. Two-part subdivisions.

Where the cancelled multiple is the second part of a two-part subdivision (e.g., ***--Foreign elements--French, [Greek, Latin, etc.]***; ***--Religious aspects--Baptists, [Catholic Church, etc.]***), only the first part of the subdivision is retained in the list, with a footnote providing instructions on further subdivision.

E.2. Single-part subdivisions

Where the cancelled multiple is the only subdivision (e.g., *** --Transliteration into Korean, [Russian, etc.]***), the subdivision is retained in the list, but italicized to indicate that it is no longer valid.

Each use of the subdivision must be specifically established under the heading for the language or language group (e.g., ***Amharic language--Transliteration into Russian***; ***Slavic languages--Transliteration into English***).

Subdivisions of this type that are established under the pattern headings for languages are not free-floating. To determine whether a subdivision used under a pattern heading is free-floating, consult the list of subdivisions below.

F. Period subdivisions

If the period subdivisions listed below and established under ***English language*** are not appropriate for another language, establish the appropriate subdivision under the specific language, for example, ***Russian language--To 1300***.

Further subdivisions. Topical and form subdivisions valid for ***English language*** in general may also be used under any specific period subdivision, for example, ***English language--Middle English, 1100-1500--Etymology--Names***.

Period subdivisions established under English language.

$y Old English, ca. 450-1100
$y Middle English, 1100-1500
$y Early modern, 1500-1700
$y 18th century
$y 19th century
$y 20th century
$y 21st century

G. List of topical subdivisions

A-C | D-G | H-O | P-R | S | T-Z

Subdivision	Notes
$x Ability testing	May Subd Geog. Use as a topical subdivision under topical headings, including languages, for tests and testing of native aptitude or acquired proficiency in a particular topic.
$x Absolute constructions	
$x Accents and accentuation	
$x Acquisition	
$x Acronyms	Use only under languages other than English.
$x Address, Forms of	
$x Adjectivals	
$x Adjective	
$x Adverb	
$x Adverbials	
$x Affixes	
$x Age differences	May Subd Geog
$x Agreement	

Subdivision	Notes
$x Alphabet	
$x Alphabet $x Religious aspects	May be subdivided topically by a religion or Christian denomination, e.g., *__English language--Religious aspects--Islam__*; *__Abidji language--Religious aspects--Catholic Church__*. Editorially establish each heading of this type. For instructions on the use of the subdivision, see H 1998.
$x Analogy	
$x Anaphora	
$x Animacy	
$x Apheresis	
$x Apposition	
$x Archaisms	
$x Article	
$x Aspect	
$x Aspiration	
$x Asyndeton	
$x Augmentatives	
$x Auxiliary verbs	
$x Binomial	
Business English	*Not a free-floating subdivision. Establish headings for *__[...] language–Business [...]__* as needed.*
$x Capitalization	
$x Case	
$x Case grammar	
$x Cataphora	
$x Categorial grammar	
$x Causative	
$x Classification	Use only under groups of languages.
$x Classifiers	
$x Clauses	
$x Clitics	
$x Cognate words	May be subdivided topically by an individual language or language group (e.g., *__English__

Subdivision	Notes
	language--Cognate words--Dutch*). Editorially establish each heading of this type.
$x Collective nouns	
$x Comparative clauses	
$x Comparison	
$x Complement	
$x Composition and exercises	
$x Compound words	
$x Computer-assisted instruction	
$x Computer-assisted instruction for foreign speakers	
Computer-assisted instruction for French, [Spanish, etc.] speakers	*Not a free-floating subdivision. For instructions on the use of this subdivision, see special provision on multiple subdivisions in the section on topical and form subdivisions.*
$x Concessive clauses	
$x Conditionals	
$x Conjunctions	
$x Connectives	
$x Consonants	
$x Context	
$x Contraction	
$x Coordinate constructions	
$x Copula	
$x Declension	
$x Definiteness	
$x Deixis	
$x Deletion	
$x Demonstratives	
$x Demonyms	
$x Denominatives	
$x Dependency grammar	
$x Determiners	
$x Diacritics	Use only under languages other than English.
$x Dialectology	
$x Dialects	May Subd Geog

Subdivision	Notes
$x Dialects $x Grammar	
$x Dialects $x Lexicology	
$x Dialects $x Morphology	
$x Dialects $x Mutual intelligibility	
$x Dialects $x Phonetics	
$x Dialects $x Phonology	
$x Dialects $x Research	May Subd Geog
$x Dialects $x Research $x Law and legislation	May Subd Geog. Further subdivide by subdivisions used under legal topics listed in H 1154.5.
$x Dialects $x Syntax	
$x Diction	
$x Dictionaries	
$x Diminutives	
$x Diphthongs	
$x Direct object	
$x Discourse analysis	
$x Dissimilation	
$x Elision	
$x Ellipsis	
$x Emphasis	
$x Enclitics	
$x Epenthesis	
$x Epithets	Use only under languages other than English.
$x Eponyms	
$x Ergative constructions	
$x Errors of usage	
$x Etymology	
$x Etymology $x Names	
$x Euphemism	
$x Exclamations	
$x Existential constructions	
$x Figures of speech	Use only under languages other than English.
$z Foreign countries	Consult H 1919.5.
$x Foreign elements	May be subdivided topically by an individual language or language group (e.g., ***French**

Subdivision	Notes
	language--Foreign elements--Arabic*). Editorially establish each heading of this type.
$x Foreign words and phrases	May be subdivided topically by an individual language or language group (e.g., ***Romance languages--Foreign words and phrases--German***). Editorially establish each heading of this type.
$x Function words	
$x Gallicisms	
$x Gemination	
$x Gender	
$x Gerund	
$x Gerundive	
$x Globalization	
$x Government	
$x Government jargon	
$x Gradation	
$x Grammar	
$x Grammar $x Theory, etc.	
$x Grammar, Comparative	
$x Grammar, Comparative $x French, [Latin, etc.]	
$x Grammar, Generative	
$x Grammar, Historical	
$x Grammatical categories	
$x Grammaticalization	
$x Graphemics	
$x Haplology	
$x Heteronyms	
$x Hiatus	
$x History	Do not further subdivide by period subdivisions.
$x Homonyms	
$x Honorific	
$x Ideophone	
$x Idioms	
$x Imperative	

Subdivision	Notes
$x Indeclinable words	
$x Indicative	
$x Indirect discourse	
$x Indirect object	
$x Infinitival constructions	
$x Infinitive	
$x Infixes	
$x Inflection	
$x Influence on foreign languages	
Influence on French, [Italian, etc.]	*Not a free-floating subdivision. For instructions on the use of this subdivision, see special provision on multiple subdivisions in the section on topical and form subdivisions.*
$x Intensification	
$x Interjections	
$x Interrogative	
$x Intonation	
$x Jargon	
$x Labiality	
$x Lexicography	
$x Lexicology	Use only under languages other than English.
$x Lexicology, Historical	Use only under languages other than English.
$x Locative constructions	
$x Machine translating	May Subd Geog
$x Markedness	
Medical English	*Not a free-floating subdivision. Establish headings for *[...] language--Medical [...]* as needed.*
$x Metonyms	
$x Metrics and rhythmics	Use only under individual ancient languages. Under individual modern languages and groups of modern languages, use ***--Rhythm***; ***--Versification***.
$x Mimetic words	
$x Modality	
$x Monosyllables	
$x Mood	

Subdivision	Notes
$x Morphemics	
$x Morphology	
$x Morphophonemics	
$x Morphosyntax	
$x Mutation	
$x Mutual intelligibility	Use only under groups of languages.
$x Nasality	
$x Negatives	
$x Neutralization	
$x New words	
$x Nominals	
$x Noun	
$x Noun phrase	
$x Null object	
$x Null subject	
$x Number	
$x Numerals	
$x Obscene words	
$x Obsolete words	
$x Onomatopoeic words	
$x Orthography and spelling	
$x Palatalization	
$x Paragraphs	
$x Parallelism	
$x Paraphrase	
$x Parenthetical constructions	
$x Paronyms	
$x Parsing	
$x Participle	
$x Particles	
$x Partitives	
$x Parts of speech	
$x Passive voice	
$x Pejoration	
$x Periphrasis	
$x Person	

Subdivision	Notes
$x Phonemics	
$x Phonetics	
$x Phonology	
$x Phonology, Comparative	
$x Phonology, Comparative $x French, [German, etc.]	
$x Phonology, Historical	
$x Phraseology	
$x Polar questions	
$x Political aspects	May Subd Geog
$x Polysemy	
$x Possessives	
$x Postpositions	
$x Prepositional phrases	
$x Prepositions	
$x Pronominals	
$x Pronoun	
$x Pronunciation	
$x Pronunciation by foreign speakers	
$x Prosodic analysis	
$x Provincialisms	May Subd Geog
$x Psychological aspects	
$x Punctuation	
$x Quantifiers	
$x Quantity	
$x Recursion	
$x Reduplication	
$x Reference	
$x Reflexives	
$x Reform	
$x Relational grammar	
$x Relative clauses	
$x Religious aspects	May be subdivided topically by a religion or Christian denomination, e.g., *__English language--Religious aspects--Islam__*; *__Abidji language--Religious aspects--Catholic Church__*. Editorially

Subdivision	Notes
	establish each heading of this type. Consult H 1998.
$x Remedial teaching	May Subd Geog
$x Resultative constructions	
$x Revival	
$x Rhetoric	
$x Rhyme	
$x Rhythm	Use as a topical subdivision under individual modern languages and groups of modern languages. Under individual ancient languages use the subdivision *--**Metrics and rhythmics***.
$x Roots	
$x Self-instruction	
$x Semantics	
$x Semantics, Historical	
$x Sentences	
$x Sex differences	May Subd Geog
$x Slang	
$x Social aspects	May Subd Geog. Do not use under ***[place]--Languages***. Use ***Sociolinguistics--[place]*** instead.
$x Sonorants	
$x Spectral analysis	
$x Spoken French, [Japanese, etc.]	May Subd Geog. Use only under languages other than English.
$x Standardization	
$x Study and teaching	May Subd Geog. May be further subdivided by subdivisions in the form *--**French, [Spanish, etc.] speakers***, where the subdivision represents the language of the persons being taught (e.g., ***English language--Study and teaching--Chinese speakers***. Editorially establish each heading of this type. When assigning the heading, do not interpose a geographic subdivision. Consult H 2110.

Subdivision	Notes
$x Study and teaching $x African American students	
$x Study and teaching $x Bilingual method	
$x Study and teaching $x Foreign speakers	
$x Study and teaching $x Foreign speakers $x Audio-visual aids	
$x Study and teaching $x Immersion method	
$x Study and teaching (Continuing education)	May Subd Geog. May be further subdivided by subdivisions in the form *--**French, [Spanish, etc.] speakers***, where the subdivision represents the language of the persons being taught (e.g., ***English language--Study and teaching (Continuing education)--Chinese speakers***. Editorially establish each heading of this type. When assigning the heading, do not interpose a geographic subdivision. Consult H 2110.
$x Study and teaching (Continuing education) $x Foreign speakers	
$x Study and teaching (Early childhood)	May Subd Geog. May be further subdivided by subdivisions in the form *--**French, [Spanish, etc.] speakers***, where the subdivision represents the language of the persons being taught (e.g., ***English language--Study and teaching (Early childhood)--Chinese speakers***. Editorially establish each heading of this type. When assigning the heading, do not interpose a geographic subdivision. Consult H 2110.
$x Study and teaching (Early childhood) $x Foreign speakers	
$x Study and teaching (Elementary)	May Subd Geog. May be further subdivided by subdivisions in the form *--**French, [Spanish, etc.] speakers***, where the subdivision represents the language of the persons being taught (e.g., ***English language--Study and teaching**

Subdivision	Notes
	(Elementary)--Chinese speakers*. Editorially establish each heading of this type. When assigning the heading, do not interpose a geographic subdivision. Consult H 2110.
$x Study and teaching (Elementary) $x Foreign speakers	
$x Study and teaching (Higher)	May Subd Geog. May be further subdivided by subdivisions in the form ***--French, [Spanish, etc.] speakers***, where the subdivision represents the language of the persons being taught (e.g., ***English language--Study and teaching (Higher)--Chinese speakers***. Editorially establish each heading of this type. When assigning the heading, do not interpose a geographic subdivision. Consult H 2110.
$x Study and teaching (Higher) $x Foreign speakers	
$x Study and teaching (Middle school)	May Subd Geog. May be further subdivided by subdivisions in the form ***--French, [Spanish, etc.] speakers***, where the subdivision represents the language of the persons being taught (e.g., ***English language--Study and teaching (Middle school)--Chinese speakers***. Editorially establish each heading of this type. When assigning the heading, do not interpose a geographic subdivision. Consult H 2110.
$x Study and teaching (Preschool)	May Subd Geog. May be further subdivided by subdivisions in the form ***--French, [Spanish, etc.] speakers***, where the subdivision represents the language of the persons being taught (e.g., ***English language--Study and teaching (Preschool)--Chinese speakers***. Editorially establish each heading of this type. When assigning the heading, do not interpose a geographic subdivision. Consult H 2110.
$x Study and teaching (Preschool) $x Foreign speakers	

Subdivision	Notes
$x Study and teaching (Primary)	May Subd Geog. May be further subdivided by subdivisions in the form *__--French, [Spanish, etc.] speakers__*, where the subdivision represents the language of the persons being taught (e.g., *__English language--Study and teaching (Primary)--Chinese speakers__*. Editorially establish each heading of this type. When assigning the heading, do not interpose a geographic subdivision. Consult H 2110.
$x Study and teaching (Primary) $x Foreign speakers	
$x Study and teaching (Secondary)	May Subd Geog. May be further subdivided by subdivisions in the form *__--French, [Spanish, etc.] speakers__*, where the subdivision represents the language of the persons being taught (e.g., *__English language--Study and teaching (Secondary)--Chinese speakers__*. Editorially establish each heading of this type. When assigning the heading, do not interpose a geographic subdivision. Consult H 2110.
$x Study and teaching (Secondary) $x Foreign speakers	
$x Style	
$x Subjectless constructions	
$x Subjunctive	
$x Subordinate constructions	
$x Substitution	
$x Suffixes and prefixes	
$x Suppletion	
$x Switch-reference	
$x Syllabication	
$x Synonyms and antonyms	
$x Syntax	
Technical English	*Not a free-floating subdivision. Establish headings for ****[...] language--Technical [...]**** as needed.*
$x Tempo	

Subdivision	Notes
$x Temporal clauses	
$x Temporal constructions	
$x Tense	
$x Terms and phrases	Use as a topical subdivision under individual languages and groups of languages for works about expressions, phrases, idioms, etc., found in those languages.
$x Textbooks	Use as a topical subdivision under languages for works about textbooks on those languages.
$x Texts	Use as a topical subdivision only under lesser-known languages, for example, *__Hittite language--Texts__*; under *__[ethnic group]--Languages__*, and *__[place]--Languages__*; or under early periods of languages (ca. pre-1500), for example, *__English language--Middle English, 1100-1500--Texts__*. Consult H 2190.
$x Texts $x Dating	Use according to instructions in H 2190 only under lesser-known languages, for example, *__Hittite language--Texts__*; under *__[ethnic group]--Languages__*, *__[groups of Indians]--Languages__* and *__[place]--Languages__*; or under early periods of languages (ca. pre-1500), for example, *__English language--Middle English, 1100-1500--Texts__*.
$x Topic and comment	
$x Transcription	May Subd Geog
$x Transitivity	
$x Translating	May Subd Geog
Translating into French, [German, etc.]	*Not a free-floating subdivision. For instructions on the use of this subdivision, see special provision on multiple subdivisions in the section on topical and form subdivisions.*
$x Transliteration	
Transliteration into Korean, [Russian, etc.]	*Not a free-floating subdivision. For instructions on the use of this subdivision, see special provision on multiple subdivisions in the section on topical and form subdivisions.*

Subdivision	Notes
$x Transmutation	
$x Usage	
$x Variation	May Subd Geog
$x Verb	
$x Verb phrase	
$x Verbals	
$x Versification	Use as a topical subdivision under individual modern languages and groups of modern languages. Under individual ancient languages use the subdivision *--**Metrics and rhythmics***.
$x Vocabulary	Use only under languages other than English.
$x Vocalization	Use only under individual Semitic languages. Under other languages use the subdivision *--**Vowels***.
$x Vocational guidance	May Subd Geog
$x Voice	
$x Vowel gradation	
$x Vowel reduction	
$x Vowels	Use as a topical subdivision under individual languages and groups of languages other than Semitic languages. Under Semitic languages, use ***--Vocalization***.
$x Word formation	
$x Word frequency	
$x Word order	
$x Writing	
Written English	*Not a free-floating subdivision. Establish headings for ****[...] language--Written [...]**** as needed.*

H. List of form subdivisions

A-C | D-P | R-Z

Subdivision	Notes
$x Acronyms $v Dictionaries	Use this subdivision combination as a form subdivision under individual languages other than English, groups of languages, and topical headings

Subdivision	Notes
	for works containing lists of acronyms in those languages or pertaining to those topics.
$v Classification	
$v Conversation and phrase books	
$v Conversation and phrase books $x Polyglot	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for accountants)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for air pilots)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for animal specialists)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for bank employees)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for beauty operators)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for businesspeople)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for caregivers)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for clergy, etc.)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for computer industry employees)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for construction industry employees)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for correctional personnel)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for dental personnel)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for diplomats)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for farmers)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for fire fighters)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for first responders)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for fishers)	

Subdivision	Notes
$v Conversation and phrase books (for flight attendants)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for gardeners)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for geologists)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for gourmets)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for homeowners)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for household employees)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for landscaping industry employees)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for lawyers)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for library employees)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for mathematicians)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for medical personnel)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for merchants)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for meteorologists)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for museum employees)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for musicians, musicologists, etc.)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for nutritionists)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for personnel department employees)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for petroleum workers)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for police)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for professionals)	

Subdivision	Notes
$v Conversation and phrase books (for restaurant and hotel personnel)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for sailors)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for school employees)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for secretaries)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for social workers)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for soldiers, etc.)	
$v Conversation and phrase books (for tourism industry employees)	
$x Dialects $v Conversation and phrase books	Use this subdivision combination as a form subdivision under individual languages and groups of languages.
$x Dialects $v Glossaries, vocabularies, etc.	Use this subdivision combination as a form subdivision under individual languages and groups of languages.
$x Dialects $v Texts	Use this subdivision combination as a form subdivision under individual languages and groups of languages.
$v Dictionaries	
$v Dictionaries $v Early works to 1700	
$v Dictionaries $x French, [Italian, etc.]	
$v Dictionaries $x Polyglot	
$v Dictionaries, Juvenile	The subdivision *--**Dictionaries, Juvenile*** may also be used under any valid topical subdivision, as appropriate (except *--**Reverse indexes*** and *--**Terms and phrases***), for lists of words pertaining to that topic, for example, ***English language--Synonyms and antonyms--Dictionaries, Juvenile***. Only a few examples are printed in this list for reference.

Subdivision	Notes
$v Dictionaries, Juvenile $x Hebrew, [Italian, etc.]	
$v Exercises for dictation	
$v Films for foreign speakers	
$v Films for French, [Spanish, etc.] speakers	
$v Glossaries, vocabularies, etc.	The subdivision ***--Glossaries, vocabularies, etc.*** may also be used under any valid topical subdivision, as appropriate (except ***--Reverse indexes*** and ***--Terms and phrases***), for lists of words pertaining to that topic, for example, ***English language--Orthography and spelling--Glossaries, vocabularies, etc.*** Only a few examples are printed in this list for reference.
$v Glossaries, vocabularies, etc. $x Polyglot	
$x Grammar $v Terminology	Use this subdivision combination as a form subdivision under individual languages and groups of languages.
$v Phonetic transcriptions	
$v Readers	Use only under languages other than English. Consult H 1975.
$v Readers $v [form]	Use as a form subdivision under languages other than English for readers in those languages in those literary forms. Consult H 1975.
$v Readers $x [topic]	Use as a form subdivision under languages other than English for readers in those languages on those topics. Consult H 1975.
$v Readers for new literates	Use only under languages other than English.
$v Reverse indexes	
$v Self-instruction	
$v Sound recordings for foreign speakers	
$v Sound recordings for French, [Spanish, etc.] speakers	
$v Terms and phrases	

Subdivision	Notes
$v Textbooks	Use as a form subdivision under individual languages and groups of languages for works that list expressions, phrases, idioms, etc., found in those languages.
$v Textbooks for English, [French, etc.] speakers	Use only under artificial languages, for example, ***Esperanto--Textbooks for Spanish speakers***.
$v Textbooks for foreign speakers	
$v Textbooks for foreign speakers $x English	Use only under languages other than English.
$v Textbooks for foreign speakers $x German, [Italian, etc.]	
$v Texts	Use according to instructions in H 2190 only under lesser-known languages, for example, ***Hittite language--Texts***; under ***[ethnic group]--Languages***, and ***[place]--Languages***; or under early periods of languages (ca. pre-1500), for example, ***English language--Middle English, 1100-1500--Texts***.
Video recordings for foreign speakers	*See --Films for foreign speakers*
Video recordings for French, [Spanish, etc.] speakers	*See --Films for French, [Spanish, etc.] speakers*

Revision history

2026-04: Updated template. Added new free-floating subdivision --Null object.

2024-08: Updated to current template. Added new free-floating subdivision --Copula.